

Style report: Balmond, Tom

Southall Congress 260620 U2400. OTB source PGNs: 96; unique games analysed: 96 from unknown date to 2026.03.07. Latest known game: 2026.03.07 vs Senith, Gunarathne as White (0-1).

Clear 1.e4 player with Scotch/Italian/Sicilian exposure as White, and a very classical Black repertoire: 1...e5 versus 1.e4, plus ...d5/Slav-QGD structures against d-pawn openings.

Prep Snapshot

Rating	FIDE ID	OTB db games	Chess.com status
1833	343420532	95	Tom_Balmond - active

Side	Games	Score	W-D-L
All	96	40.1%	34-9-53
White	51	35.3%	15-6-30
Black	45	45.6%	19-3-23

Repertoire Evidence

Area	Most common lines
White first moves	e4 (100.0%)
White line prefixes	e4 e5 Nf3 Nc6 d4 exd4 (15.7%), e4 c6 d4 d5 Nc3 dxe4 (11.8%), e4 c5 Nf3 d6 d4 cxd4 (9.8%), e4 e6 d4 d5 Nc3 Nf6 (7.8%)
Black first replies	e4 e5 (48.9%), d4 d5 (35.6%), c4 e5 (6.7%), e4 e6 (6.7%), Nf3 d5 (2.2%)
Black line prefixes	e4 e5 Nf3 Nc6 Bc4 Bc5 (17.8%), e4 e5 Nf3 Nc6 Bb5 Nf6 (11.1%), d4 d5 Nc3 Nf6 Bf4 Bf5 (8.9%), e4 e5 Nf3 Nc6 d4 exd4 (6.7%)
Opening families	Unknown (35.4%), Sicilian Defense (13.5%), French Defense (9.4%), Scotch Game (8.3%), Italian Game (7.3%)

Online Account Context

Strong overlap: 1.e4 as White with Scotch/Italian/Sicilian/Caro-Kann/French exposure, and as Black 1...e5 versus 1.e4 plus ...d5/Slav-QGD style against 1.d4. Slower Chess.com games are especially close to OTB.

Stockfish Sample

Stockfish 17.1 depth 8 sampled 56 games and 1384 target moves. Average loss was 0.51 pawns; serious-error rate 13.7%; blunder-rate 5.7%.

Phase	Moves	Avg loss	Serious
opening	336	0.26 pawns	6.0%
middlegame	986	0.59 pawns	16.2%
endgame	62	0.65 pawns	16.1%

Largest sampled swings

Game	Move	Best	Loss	Type
2024-09-01 Balmond, Tom - Davies, Neil 0-1	45. Qe2	Qd5	9.75 pawns	coordination
2024.?? ?? Balmond, Tom - Davies, Neil T 0-1	45. Qe2	Qd5	9.75 pawns	coordination
2025-03-01 Davison, Chris - Balmond, Tom 1-0	50. bxa4	Bxf5	9.29 pawns	tactics
2024-09-01 Brennan, Henry - Balmond, Tom 1-0	48. Kd7	Bxc7	6.14 pawns	queenless play
2025.08.18 Balmond, Tom - Patel, Zain 1-0	55. Rb8	Rb7+	5.8 pawns	coordination

Strengths

- The repertoire is coherent across OTB and the high-confidence Chess.com account.

- He is comfortable taking space and playing open-piece middlegames from 1.e4.
- As Black he often chooses principled central replies rather than passive systems.

Weaknesses To Test

- Because his repertoire is so identifiable, your opening prep can be concrete and narrow.
- Scotch/Italian structures can leave early tactical loose ends if you know the exact equalising plan.
- He has several younger-player games where momentum mattered; stopping the first initiative is worth a lot.

Your Strategy

- With Black, prepare directly for 1.e4 and especially Scotch/Italian move orders. Do not improvise the equalising plan at the board.
- With White, expect 1...e5 or solid ...d5 systems. Pick a line that asks him to defend rather than simply develop.
- If you reach a level middlegame, keep pieces coordinated and avoid unnecessary pawn hooks; make him show a second plan after the first wave.

Saved Prep Lines In This Folder

No separate white/black helper prep PGNs were found in this player folder.

Appendix: Evidence Tables

Top ECO Codes

ECO	Games	Share
?	18	18.8%
C45	7	7.3%
C54	7	7.3%
C02	4	4.2%
B00	4	4.2%
C67	4	4.2%
C11	4	4.2%
B22	3	3.1%

Top Opening Families

Family	Games	Share
Unknown	34	35.4%
Sicilian Defense	13	13.5%
French Defense	9	9.4%
Scotch Game	8	8.3%
Italian Game	7	7.3%
Slav Defense	6	6.2%
Ruy Lopez	3	3.1%
Rapport-Jobava System	3	3.1%

Source Notes

Original source bucket	Hits before final dedupe
mega	14
chess-results	46
lichess fide page	3
lichess broadcast database	59
britbase	10
chessbites	14

Prep collection notes

- Chessscope checked: player page advertised 62 broadcast games; per-game crawl was skipped because the full Lichess broadcast database was streamed and filtered by FIDE ID/name.
- BritBase public PGN second pass added 10 unique games.
- ChessBites public game-page pass added 14 unique games from 14 fetched PGNs.
- Duplicate cleanup on 2026-06-19T21:09:44+00:00: removed 43 duplicate Files-side PGNs, rewrote the app-side source PGN to 103 unique games, and rebuilt the OTB database from 145 to 102 games.
- Duplicate cleanup on 2026-06-19T21:11:17+00:00: removed 7 duplicate Files-side PGNs, rewrote the app-side source PGN to 96 unique games, and rebuilt the OTB database from 102 to 95 games.

Method

Opening and result statistics were calculated from the deduped combined app-side OTB prep PGN. Original source bucket counts are kept only as collection provenance and can exceed the final unique game total. Stockfish sampling checked target-side moves from move 5 onward in recent and result-diverse OTB games. Chess.com account comments use the existing Southall opening-comparison audit and are not merged into the OTB statistics unless explicitly stated.